Finally the territorial limits imposed by the Cold War on capitalist expansion were broken. Already in the 1960s and '70s the level of capital concentration had reached new and frightening heights, breeding a few layers of large capitalists in the subaltern countries integrated with this dynamic; even though subordinate, they, in turn, need to ensure large areas for the reproduction of their capitals. We have now come to the third and fundamental characteristic of capital-imperialism: if the original model of capital concentration was that of a fusion between industry (then understood as industrial units) and large banks, the new scale generated more complex templates, including the really pornographic fusion of large property. The size of property concentration exploded the then existing segmentation frontiers (primary, secondary and tertiary sectors, in descriptive terms; or in Marxist terms, industrial capital – that which is dedicated to the appropriation of surplus value, and not merely 'manufacturing' – banking capital and commercial capital). Even though each mega-property can have one of these activities as its origin or principal centre, its dimensions tend to make it owners not only of the means of production but, above all, of the capacity to use those means in whatever space, whatever activity able to extract value (even fictitiously) and under whatever conditions. We call this form the ownership of the social resources of production, which includes as well as transcends ownership of the means of production. In other words, the effective capital is concentrated in a monetary form, making it more abstract, yet its existential condition continues to be that of urging – every day more forceful and impatient – the appropriation of value.

This capital concentration needs and urges the production of workers, the only ones who create the value that reproduces and nourishes capital. This fourth characteristic of capital-imperialism is as basic as the third one. Far from a worldwide reduction of labour,[10] worker numbers constantly increase, just as the creation of new ways to make them more dependent on the market and therefore supposedly more docile increase. Marx (1996:339–383) had already satirised economists who idyllically called 'primitive accumulation' that which in reality was the dramatic production of the social bases that permanently support capitalism: the expropriation of rural peoples, triggering large socially dispossessed masses needing to sell that which they have left, their capacity to work. He therefore denounced the condition of this liberty, which at its core was necessity leading to submission to capital.

In the last 50 years, the global expropriation of millions of peasants has accelerated, producing new 'poor people' (as they are treated by international agencies) in good measure resulting from the 'Green Revolution',[11] which –